

er cache, and delete cookies and browsing history.

4.11.2 SmartDefrag

(www.iobit.com/SmartDefrag/)

This application adds some additional features to the defragmenting tool that comes with Windows. One of them is the Auto Defrag feature, which continuously operates in the background when the CPU is idle, ensuring minimal defrag to disk contents. It also offers an express defrag option, which attempts to only defrag selected files and not the whole volume, and therefore takes considerably less time than a normal defrag. Scheduled defragging is also supported.



There's more to defragmenting than the Windows tool

4.11.3 HD Tune

(www.hdtune.com)

This utility offer a bundle of tools to monitor and maintain a hard disk. It can display the hard disk features, its temperature, and SMART properties. It can scan the disk surface for errors and can also benchmark the transfer rates.



Keep a close eye on your hard drives

4.12 An Encryption Utility

Data security involves two issues: keeping data safe and keeping data private. Backup utilities meet the need to keep data safe, while encryption utilities ensure data remains private.

4.12.1 TrueCrypt (www.truecrypt.org)

This encryption utility works by creating a virtual drive into which files that require protection have to be transferred. The first step of using TC is the creation of a volume, which can be a file or a